

one place, and with Apple's much awaited voice controlled smart hub – the Homepod – they now have a more complete ecosystem for smart homes, giving manufacturers more incentive to incorporate HomeKit in their devices.

Home

To complement the HomeKit platform and provide a central command center for all your HomeKit enabled smart devices, Apple brought out the Home app, and it was something which was missing from the ecosystem. Apple Home lets you control all your HomeKit enabled smart devices from any iPad or iPhone running iOS 10, Apple TV and even Apple Watch.

HomeKit was a good platform with its end to end encryption, but you had to rely on third party applications from different vendors and even then it wasn't possible to create elaborate automatic actions which one can perform using existing smart home hubs. The Home is not a smart home hub replacement though.

It doesn't have many new features, but rather brings all the features and functionalities that come along with HomeKit under one roof – in one app. Most importantly it lets you create automatic actions and fully utilize the potential of having a house full of HomeKit enabled smart devices.

Starting up Home is easy. It comes preinstalled with the latest iOS. Search for 'Home', launch the app and get a quick walk through tutorial to get acquainted with the UI.

The features and functionalities are divided into 3 tabs inside the app- Home, Rooms and Automation.

Home

This is the main landing page of the app where you see all your HomeKit enabled devices and can start building your smart home from. Connect your devices to your home network, and tap the 'Add Accessory' button. Home will scan your home network for all available devices, pair with them and add them to this tab. All your added devices can be accessed directly from here. You can tap various icons of different accessories like your smart lights, drapes and thermostat and toggle them on and off. To access a device's more specific controls, long press the accessory and you will see all the controls related to the device pop up fullscreen.

Once you have set it all up and opened the app, the home tab will list down all the active devices in your smart home like number of lights turned on or open locks. Press the edit button in the top left corner, and you get